

6.1 Opera 9.1

Opera burst on to the browser scene with the claim of being the fastest browser available, and it is. That apart, there are many other features of Opera that give the impression that it has been very thoughtfully put together. Creating a happy browsing experience is Opera's core philosophy, and it is easy for users of Opera to find fault with other browsers.

This usability comes at a price, though—reduced compatibility. Many sites are not tested or optimised to work with Opera, and as a result, some Web pages do not render as expected, and page objects malfunction. Menus and other script-based Web site elements are notable problem areas. An example can be seen at <http://www.novell.com/services/>, where activating the top row menus causes the picture in the middle to disappear. As mentioned by the Opera team at <http://operawatch.com/news/2006/06/an-inside-look-at-how-opera-works-on-site-compatibility.html>, the inconsistencies seen are many times the result of improper code rather than deficiencies in Opera. But if the ones you regularly visit are displayed fine, Opera is the browser for you.

Opera offers the most screen space among all the browsers, and unlike the others, it is feature-rich right out of the box. There is no need to install plugins or add-ons to get the best browsing experience. The feature list is extensive, and at the end of this brief feature description, the only question one would have to ask is this: How is all this squeezed into a 6 MB file?

A description of all of Opera's features is beyond our scope here, and we talk about the ones that can quickly become indispensable.

- **The Context Menu:** Like all good applications, Opera comes with a powerful right-click. “Paste and Go” is a nifty feature that pops up on right-clicking on the address bar. Unlike the regular “Paste” function, Paste and Go saves you the effort of an additional press of the [Enter] key.